

NETWORKING

Great now that you know everything about what goes into a PC, how do you make it connect to the outside world?
After all a lonely PC is a sad PC.

Most of you have an internet connection at home and are quite capable at troubleshooting when things go wrong. Some have a 'guy' whom they can call to get it done while others call tech support. However, most of the hardware was chosen for you, this eliminated the entire task of going through the vast array of devices which you could have used. How many of you use the stock router/modem that your ISP provided? That too you might be paying rent on that every month. Let's say you now want to optimise things a bit, get the WiFi in all corners of the house and get rid of all the wires. Read on to figure out what hardware does what and make an informed decision.

Types of connections

Networking by definition is about bringing two or more computers together, now you must be getting your internet either as part of a group (LAN) or individually. They can co-exist too.

Dial-up

Dial-up uses a phone call via your telephone network to connect to a modem operated by your ISP (Internet Service Provider). The modem is a device